restaurant recommended by Trevor Penney, our former specialist fielding coach. The plan involved a slice or two of deep crust, washed down by a couple of bottles of Mexican beer as we watched the sun set over the Himalayas.

Dharamsala is a beautiful place, ringed by cedar forests. The air is so clean and fresh. Appropriately, since it is home to the Dalai Lama and the Tibetan government in exile, it is a tranquil contrast to the teeming cities we are used to visiting. The three of us reasoned that we would get away with the expedition because we are not instantly recognizable folk heroes in the mould of KP.

It was Friday, and traffic was strangely heavy. Without exaggeration, our car was surrounded by around a thousand people as soon as it pulled up at the restaurant. I don't know how they knew we were going to be there, but once we were bundled through the crowd, they decided to storm the place. It was absolute bedlam.

Armed security guards took us upstairs and locked us in a bedroom, where the occupant's underpants were still on the double bed. They devised a secret door-knocking code to smuggle the pizza and beer in, so we sat there for an hour or so, giggling at the absurdity of eating with guys who were waving guns.

And then we tried to leave.

I'd never seen anything like it. There were now five thousand people there, waiting for us. The most adventurous were blocking the stairway, phones at the ready. They were desperate for any form of contact. It wasn't particularly dangerous, apart from the fact someone could easily have been hurt in the crush, or during the subsequent stampede after our car, but it was surreal.

We never got the chance to relax and enjoy the serenity of the mountain top. Perhaps there was a moral there …